

Role Walkthrough Guide: Finance Specialist

Financial Reconciliation & Billing Manual

NOTE: ****Role Designation:**** `finance` (Finance Specialist / Billing & Margins Analyst) ****Primary Purpose:**** Audit engagement profitability analysis, margin reconciliation, contractor cost verification, expense billing, and client invoicing readiness. ****Supported Entities:**** KGAC & KPL

1. Role Scope & Key Responsibilities

As a **Finance Specialist**, you safeguard the commercial health and billing integrity of KGAC and KPL. You reconcile project revenues against labor expenses, contractor day-rates, and field incidentals to ensure healthy profit margins and prompt client billing.

Summary of Responsibilities

- 1. Audit Margins & Reconciliation:** Calculate exact profitability per audit by comparing client billing fees against auditor labor hours and contractor rates.
- 2. Expense Billing Governance:** Review and approve reimbursable audit expenses (hotel, fuel, flight, daily per-diem allowances).
- 3. Contractor Cost Auditing:** Validate vendor agency invoices against billable man-days recorded in the system.
- 4. Entity Revenue Allocation:** Ensure billing records, client contracts, and vendor payments route cleanly to the correct company balance sheet (**KGAC** or **KPL**).
- 5. Commercial Data Exports:** Export margin models and billing registers in CSV and Excel formats.

2. System Access & Navigation Overview

NAVIGATION ITEM	ROUTE	KEY PURPOSE
Audit Margins	/reconciliation	Client revenue vs direct labor and overhead cost reconciliation.
Expense Billing	/billing	Reimbursable audit expense management and invoice prep.
Man-Days	/man-days	Billable man-days breakdown: internal employees vs external contractors.
Calendar	/calendar	Read-only access to time allocations across projects.
Dashboard	/dashboard	High-level platform metrics and utilization data.
Internal Assets	/assets	Asset registry and depreciation / replacement cost review.
My Profile	/profile	User credentials and security settings.

3. Step-by-Step Operating Procedures

3.1 Authentication, Registration & Onboarding

Finance team members access billing and margin models via:

- **Sign In with Google:** Click "Sign in with Google" with your authorized company email.
- **Username & Password:** Click "Username & Password", enter username (without domain) and password.
- **Create Account (New Finance Staff):** Register via "Don't have an account? Sign up". Newly registered accounts display **Account Pending Approval** until assigned the `finance` role by an Administrator.
- **Entity Confirmation:** Confirm KGAC or KPL on first login.

 SCREENSHOT: SS01A: Initial Login Screen with Google SSO

Target File: `../screenshots/SS01A_login_google.png`

 SCREENSHOT: SS01B: Username and Password Sign In Form

Target File: `../screenshots/SS01B_login_username.png`

 SCREENSHOT: SS01C: Create User / Sign Up Form

Target File: `../screenshots/SS01C_create_account.png`

 SCREENSHOT: SS01D: Account Pending Approval Screen

Target File: `../screenshots/SS01D_account_pending_approval.png`

3.2 Conducting Audit Margins Reconciliation

1. Navigate to **Audit Margins** (`/reconciliation`).
2. Filter by Client Engagement and Audit Month.
3. Review the financial breakdown:
 - **Contract Value:** Total fees agreed with the client for the store audit.
 - **Internal Labor Cost:** Automatically calculated as: $(\text{Hours Logged}) \times (\text{Auditor Hourly Base Rate})$.
 - **Vendor Contractor Cost:** Calculated as: $(\text{Contractor Days}) \times (\text{Vendor Day-Rate})$.
 - **Reimbursable Expenses:** Travel, lodging, meals.
 - **Net Margin:** The resulting gross profit figure and percentage margin.
4. If an engagement shows a negative or sub-target margin (<25%):
 - Click into the engagement details to identify whether excess hours were logged, or whether expensive external contractors were over-utilized.

 SCREENSHOT: SS28: Audit Margins Reconciliation Panel

Target File: `../screenshots/SS28_audit_margins_reconciliation.png`

3.2 Processing Expense Billing & Reimbursables

1. Navigate to **Expense Billing** (`/billing`).
2. Review audit expense claims submitted by field teams.
3. Verify supporting receipts for:
 - Inter-city travel and local transit.
 - Accommodation and per-diem meals.
 - Miscellaneous supplies.
4. Flag items as **Billable to Client** or **Internal Company Expense**.
5. Click **Approve for Invoicing**.
6. Export the final billing schedule via **Export as Excel** to generate customer invoices.

 SCREENSHOT: SS29: Expense Billing Dashboard

Target File: `../screenshots/SS29_expense_billing_dashboard.png`

3.3 Auditing Contractor Man-Days for Vendor Payments

1. Open **Man-Days** (`/man-days`).
2. Switch filter to **Contractor Staff**.
3. Group by **Vendor Agency Name**.
4. Cross-reference the logged days with incoming vendor invoices:
 - Verify that the vendor did not bill for 10 days if the contractor only worked 8 days on-site.
5. Export the verified contractor summary in CSV/Excel for accounts payable sign-off.

 SCREENSHOT: SS30: Man-Days Contractor Summary

Target File: `../screenshots/SS30_man_days_summary.png`

4. Finance Review Standards Checklist

- [] **Billing Timeliness:** Reconcile audit margins within 3 business days of audit completion.
- [] **Receipt Verification:** Never approve an expense over ₹500 without a valid tax invoice or digital receipt attached.
- [] **Contractor Rate Match:** Ensure contractor rates applied in the margin calculation match the signed Master Service Agreement (MSA).

- [] **Export Verification:** Ensure both CSV and Excel exports reflect all adjustments before transmission to accounting.